

ANTI-MODERN-DAY SLAVERY AND HUMAN TRAFFICKING POLICY

1. Policy Statement

GIFON is firmly committed to the eradication of all forms of modern slavery and human trafficking in its operations and supply chains. Modern slavery — including forced labour, bonded labour, child labour, servitude, and trafficking — is a gross violation of human rights and has no place in any aspect of our work or partnerships.

2. Purpose

This policy aims to:

- Prevent and detect modern slavery and human trafficking in any form.
- Establish mechanisms for due diligence, reporting, and enforcement.
- Promote ethical practices in procurement, employment, and partnerships.

- Comply with applicable Nigerian and international legal obligations.

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, trustees, volunteers, contractors, consultants, grantees, and vendors of GIFON.
- All projects, programs, and funded activities, both in Nigeria and internationally.
- All third parties and stakeholders acting on behalf of or in collaboration with GIFON.

4. Definitions

- **Modern Slavery:** Umbrella term covering slavery, servitude, forced or compulsory labour, and human trafficking.
- **Human Trafficking:** The recruitment, transportation, transfer, harbouring, or receipt of persons for the purpose of exploitation.
- **Forced Labor:** All work or service exacted from any person under the menace of penalty and for which the person has not offered himself voluntarily.

- **Child Labor:** Employment of children below the minimum legal working age or under exploitative conditions.

5. Legal Frameworks

This policy aligns with:

- Nigeria's Trafficking in Persons (Prohibition) Enforcement and Administration Act, 2015
- The Labour Act (Cap L1 Laws of the Federation of Nigeria 2004)
- United Nations Protocol to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons (Palermo Protocol)
- ILO Conventions on Forced Labour (C029 & C105)
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights

6. Risk Areas

GIFON recognizes the following high-risk areas where modern slavery may occur:

- Supply chains (especially goods/services sourced from informal or outsourced providers)
- Recruitment and labour brokerage
- Construction, security, janitorial, and catering contracts

- Partnership arrangements with local or rural service providers
- Field-level project implementation in remote or underserved communities

7. Responsibilities

7.1 Board of Trustees

- Oversight of organizational compliance and risk exposure.

7.2 Executive Director

- Lead implementation of anti-slavery measures and ensure accountability.

7.3 Human Resources

- Enforce fair labour practices and ethical recruitment standards.
- Prevent child and forced labour in staffing and contracting.

7.4 Procurement Unit

- Vet vendors and partners for anti-slavery compliance.
- Include anti-slavery clauses in contracts and tenders.

7.5 Employees and Volunteers

- Adhere to the policy and report any suspicions of abuse or trafficking.

8. Prevention and Due Diligence

8.1 Recruitment Practices

- No recruitment fees or coercive contracts allowed.
- Workers shall be free to terminate employment with reasonable notice.
- Employment shall be voluntary and based on written agreements.

8.2 Contractor and Vendor Screening

- All suppliers must undergo modern slavery risk assessment.
- Contracts must include warranties of compliance and audit rights.
- Preference for certified ethical vendors (Fair Trade, ISO 26000, etc.).

8.3 Training and Awareness

- All staff shall undergo annual training on modern slavery risks and reporting.
- Field teams and partners shall be educated on rights, indicators, and red flags.

9. Protection of Whistleblowers

- Retaliation against whistleblowers is strictly prohibited.
- Reports will be investigated confidentially, promptly, and sensitively.

10. Monitoring and Enforcement

- Internal audits shall include checks for labour and human rights abuses.
- Annual slavery risk assessments shall be conducted across the value chain.
- Non-compliant vendors or partners may be terminated or blacklisted.

11. Disciplinary Measures

Violations of this policy will result in:

- Disciplinary action (including termination of employment or contract)
- Legal prosecution where applicable
- Remedial measures for affected persons (referrals, support, reintegration)

12. Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed:

- **Biennially**, or
- Upon changes in legislation, risk exposure, or operational scope.

Recommendations shall be submitted by the Compliance and Risk Unit to the Board.

13. Related Policies

- Human Rights and Ethics Policy
- Whistleblower Protection Policy
- Procurement and Vendor Management Policy
- Safeguarding Policy
- Code of Conduct and Professional Ethics